# Keep More Legally - Tax Efficiency Checklist

A lawful framework for records, wrappers, entities, timing, fees and professional review.

**MATRIX REPROGRAMMED - DETAILED WEALTH GUIDE**

Reader outcome: Create a documented annual tax-efficiency review and a list of questions for a qualified professional.

Best for: Individuals and small-business owners who want to reduce avoidable leakage without evasion or artificial schemes.

Edition checked: 2026-07-20

**Educational information only. No personalised financial, investment, legal or tax advice. No guaranteed outcomes.**

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## 1. Legal only

Tax planning changes the timing, form or location of lawful activity within the rules; evasion hides or falsifies facts.
Reject false invoices, undeclared cash, sham residence, nominee ownership, artificial losses and backdated documents.
A structure must have commercial, family, investment or governance purpose beyond a tax slogan.
Written professional advice does not protect false facts supplied by the client.

## 2. Start with accurate records

Reconcile bank, platform, payroll, sales, purchases, debt, investments and asset disposals.
Keep invoices, receipts, contracts, mileage or travel evidence and allocation methods.
Separate personal and business transactions.
Record acquisition cost and improvements for assets where future gain calculations may depend on them.
Missing records often cost more than advanced planning saves.

## 3. Map the total tax cost

Include income tax, social contributions, payroll charges, corporate tax, VAT, property taxes, capital-gains tax and compliance cost where relevant.
Compare after-tax cash available personally, cash retained in a business and future extraction tax.
Model more than one year because a short-term saving can create a later cost.
Do not compare legal forms using one headline rate.

## 4. Lawful allowances and expenses

Claim only expenses permitted for the activity and supported by evidence.
Document mixed-use allocation for home, vehicle, phone or equipment.
Compare simplified allowances with actual-expense regimes where permitted.
A deductible expense still costs money; do not spend one euro merely to save a fraction in tax.

## 5. Account and investment wrappers

Identify eligible retirement, savings and investment wrappers in the jurisdiction.
Compare contribution limits, access restrictions, investment range, fees and tax on

withdrawal.
A wrapper does not make the underlying asset safe or suitable.
Record beneficiary and succession treatment as well as annual tax treatment.

## 6. Business form and compensation

Compare individual business, micro regime and company forms using realistic profit, costs, social protection and administration.
Model salary, dividends, retained profit, pension contributions and benefits only under current rules.
Protect working capital and solvency before extracting cash.
Related-party payments must reflect real services, legal authority and documentation.

## 7. VAT and indirect tax

Determine registration, threshold, place-of-supply and invoicing obligations before quoting prices.
Separate collected VAT from revenue.
Check cross-border goods and digital services carefully.
Late registration, incorrect invoices and unrecorded imports can create penalties larger than expected profit.

## 8. Timing and realisation

Tax may depend on payment, invoice, disposal, vesting, distribution, residence or ownership dates.
Do not manipulate dates or documentation; plan future lawful transactions before they occur.
Compare realising a gain, using losses, donating, transferring or holding under current rules and non-tax objectives.
Maintain liquidity for the tax due; a taxable gain may not produce equivalent cash.

## 9. Cross-border warning

Residence, source, permanent establishment, social security, withholding, reporting and treaty rules can conflict.
Citizenship, residence, domicile and company registration are not interchangeable concepts.
Do not move assets or create foreign entities based on online claims of zero tax.
Obtain advice in every relevant jurisdiction and ensure advisers coordinate assumptions.

## 10. Annual checklist

[ ] Records reconciled.

[ ] Allowances and deadlines checked on official sources.

[ ] Entity remains suitable.

[ ] Investment and pension wrappers reviewed.

[ ] Fees and interest quantified.

[ ] VAT and payroll reviewed.

[ ] Capital gains and losses recorded.

[ ] Beneficiaries and estate consequences reviewed.

[ ] Tax cash reserve funded.

[ ] Defined adviser question prepared.

## 11. Adviser question sheet

What exact facts and documents does the conclusion depend on?

Which law, guidance or case supports it?

What changes if income, residence, turnover or ownership changes?

What are the setup, annual and exit costs?

What reporting is required and who is responsible?

What is the non-tax commercial or family purpose?

What is the downside if the authority disagrees?

## 12. How to use this guide

Purpose: Create a documented annual tax-efficiency review and a list of questions for a qualified professional.

Best reader: Individuals and small-business owners who want to reduce avoidable leakage without evasion or artificial schemes.

Read the guide once without taking action. On the second pass, complete the checklists and write down the evidence supporting each decision.

Replace every example number with your own verified amount, date, fee, tax treatment, contract term or source document.

Do not treat a checklist tick as proof. Keep copies of the underlying statements, quotations, filings, contracts and calculations.

For major decisions, use this guide to prepare better questions for a regulated adviser, accountant, lawyer, lender or insurer.

## 13. Evidence standard

Tier 1: law, regulator, tax authority, court, audited accounts, official product document or signed contract.

Tier 2: recognised institutional research that states its methodology, date and limitations.

Tier 3: reputable reporting used to identify questions, not to replace primary evidence.
Tier 4: marketing, social posts, testimonials, screenshots and anonymous claims. Treat these as unverified leads.
Write the source date beside every changing figure. A correct figure without a date can become misleading.
Separate facts, estimates, assumptions and scenarios. Never allow a scenario to be presented as a forecast or guarantee.
A company, fund, adviser, trust, structure, transaction or association is not proof of misconduct.

## 14. Decision record worksheet

[ ] State the decision in one sentence.

[ ] State the desired result and deadline.

[ ] List the three strongest pieces of supporting evidence.

[ ] List the three strongest reasons the decision may fail.

[ ] Record the maximum acceptable loss of money, time and flexibility.

[ ] Record the smallest reversible test.

[ ] Name the person responsible for checking legal, tax or regulatory consequences.

[ ] Set the next review date and the evidence that would cause you to stop.

## 15. Professional advice triggers

Seek regulated investment advice when product suitability, risk capacity, pensions, insurance or a large portfolio decision is unclear.

Seek tax advice before changing residence, extracting company cash, transferring assets, using trusts, gifting substantial sums or entering cross-border arrangements.

Seek legal advice before signing guarantees, shareholder agreements, acquisition contracts, complex leases, loan security or beneficiary arrangements.

Seek accounting advice when turnover, VAT, payroll, inventory, multiple activities or company-group transactions become material.

Use a defined written question. Paying for broad reassurance without documents or calculations rarely produces a useful answer.

## 16. Subject focus map

Use the following subject anchors as named checkpoints. For each checkpoint, record the fact, source, date, assumption, decision and next review date.

LEGAL ONLY: define what this checkpoint means for this guide, what evidence supports it, and what result would cause you to change course.

TOTAL TAX COST: define what this checkpoint means for this guide, what evidence supports it, and what result would cause you to change course.

RECORDS: define what this checkpoint means for this guide, what evidence supports it,

and what result would cause you to change course.
ADVISER QUESTION: define what this checkpoint means for this guide, what evidence supports it, and what result would cause you to change course.
Do not mark a checkpoint complete because an action was taken. Mark it complete only when the result and supporting evidence have been recorded.
Where a checkpoint depends on another person, institution, platform or contract, record that dependency and a fallback route.
Rank checkpoints by potential harm if ignored, not by how interesting or easy they appear.
At the end of each review, choose one checkpoint to advance and one risk to reduce before adding a new objective.

## 17. Worked decision case

Write a real decision from your own situation at the top of a blank page. Examples include changing work, launching an offer, choosing an account, buying an asset, restructuring a business or rejecting a proposal.
Baseline: state the current cash, income, liabilities, commitments, ownership, legal position and time available. Use documents rather than memory where possible.
Desired result: describe the measurable outcome, deadline and reason. Remove vague language such as more, better, passive, safe or guaranteed.
Options: include the proposed action, a smaller reversible test, a diversified alternative, delaying the action and doing nothing.

Evidence: attach at least three independent sources. Identify which evidence is official, contractual, audited, estimated, promotional or missing.
Economics: show setup cost, recurring cost, cash timing, fees, tax reserve, downside loss, opportunity cost and the point at which the decision becomes worthwhile.
Risk: identify concentration, liquidity, legal, operational, fraud, health, relationship and behavioural risks. Name the risk that could create irreversible harm.
Professional review: write the exact question that requires an accountant, lawyer, regulated adviser, lender, insurer or technical specialist.
Decision: state proceed, test, delay or reject. Record the maximum commitment and the evidence required before any further commitment.
Review: set a dated checkpoint. Write the result that would confirm the decision, the result that would require adjustment and the result that would trigger an immediate stop.

## 18. 90-day implementation workbook

Week 1 - Establish the baseline. Reconcile the relevant accounts, contracts, statements, fees, tax records, responsibilities and deadlines.
Week 2 - Define the result. Choose one measurable outcome and remove actions that do not directly support it or protect an essential risk.
Week 3 - Gather primary evidence. Use official registers, filings, signed terms, current quotations and dated institutional data.
Week 4 - Compare alternatives. Include a lower-cost option, a lower-risk option, a

reversible test and the option to wait.
Week 5 - Model the economics. Build downside, base and upside cases while treating every uncertain input as an assumption.
Week 6 - Verify identity and authority. Confirm who owns, controls, advises, holds money, signs contracts and bears liability.
Week 7 - Run the smallest useful test. Limit money, time and legal commitment while collecting evidence about real demand or performance.
Week 8 - Reconcile actual results. Compare promised, expected and actual cost, time, cash flow, quality, risk and customer or counterparty behaviour.
Week 9 - Repair the constraint. Improve the single factor currently limiting income, retention, safety, liquidity, delivery or evidence quality.
Week 10 - Install controls. Add calendar reminders, approval limits, account separation, written procedures, backups and review ownership.
Week 11 - Decide whether to scale. Increase commitment only when the test produced measurable value and the downside remains affordable.
Week 12 - Complete the evidence file. Store the decision record, sources, calculations, contracts, results, lessons and next review date.
Day 90 - Write a one-page conclusion: what was established, what remains uncertain, what changed, what will continue and what will stop.

## 19. Review, escalation and stop rules

Review monthly when the decision affects recurring cash, debt, customer commitments,

investment contributions or essential protection.
Review immediately after a material legal change, tax notice, contract change, security incident, missed payment, large loss, health event or relationship change.
Escalate to a qualified professional when the facts cross jurisdictions, involve regulated products, create personal guarantees, affect beneficiaries or cannot be reversed cheaply.
Pause when required documents are missing, identities cannot be independently verified, costs are unclear or the counterparty resists reasonable due diligence.
Stop when the action requires deception, undeclared income, false invoices, hidden beneficial ownership, unaffordable leverage or essential-living money.
Stop when actual cash use, delivery time or loss exceeds the written limit.
Stop when the central evidence is corrected, withdrawn, contradicted by a stronger source or no longer current.
Do not move a stop limit merely because money, pride or time has already been committed. Sunk cost is not evidence that continuing is rational.
Record every exception to the plan, who approved it and why. Repeated exceptions indicate the plan or control is not working.
A stopped action can still be a successful decision when it prevents a larger loss and preserves the ability to act later.

## 20. Evidence and legal boundary

This is educational information, not personalised financial, investment, legal,

accounting or tax advice.
Investments can fall in value. Businesses can fail. Debt, leverage, illiquidity, tax and legal obligations can create losses greater than the expected benefit.
Rules and thresholds change. Verify the current official position on the date of action.
Never use false invoices, hidden ownership, undeclared income, sham transactions, misleading applications or borrowed essential-living money.
No return, saving, valuation, tax outcome or business result is guaranteed.

## 21. Official research routes

1. BOFiP - French income tax bands -
https://bofip.impots.gouv.fr/bofip/2491-PGP.html/identifiant=BOI-IR-LIQ-20-10-20260407
2. impots.gouv.fr - Assurance-vie and PEA -
https://www.impots.gouv.fr/particulier/lassurance-vie-et-le-pea-0
3. impots.gouv.fr - Investment income -
https://www.impots.gouv.fr/particulier/les-revenus-mobiliers
4. French Economy Ministry - Micro-enterprise income declarations -
https://www.economie.gouv.fr/entreprises/gerer-sa-micro-entreprise/micro-entrepreneurs-comment-declarer-vos-revenus
5. Entreprendre.Service-Public.fr - Business creation -
https://entreprendre.service-public.fr/